



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Covenant Classical Academy

School Website: <https://www.covenantclassicalacademy.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS STARTUP

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Covenant Classical Academy NC 27909 demonstrates a robust CLASSICAL orientation across all six classical categories. The public-facing materials describe a Christ-centered, biblical worldview anchored in a Trivium-based curriculum (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) and a Great-Books-inspired "great conversation," with explicit attention to virtue formation, communal worship, mentorship, and strong partnerships with parents. The faculty is presented as both living exemplars and mentors, and parental involvement is framed as a core aspect of the educational project. Taken together, the school aligns strongly with the classical model while embedding a thoroughly Christian theological framework throughout its pedagogy, curriculum, and community life. Evidence drawn from Covenant Classical Academy's public materials shows explicit commitments to Christ-centered education, biblical integration, the Trivium, Great Books, and family partnerships, all supported by a theology-centered faculty and governance structure.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

- Evidence: The school frames itself as Christ-centered and biblically grounded across instruction, with daily Bible integration, gospel-centered curriculum, and covenant theology; creedal affirmations (Apostles' Creed, Nicene Creed) are explicitly referenced, and theology is integrated into institutional practice.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include Christ-centered, biblical truth, theology, creed, liturgy/worship (via prayer and worship), imago Dei, and catechesis. Negative indicators (relativism, secular humanism, values-clarification) are not present in the materials. Estimated keyword presence strongly favors positive signals.
- Why this rating: The materials clearly satisfy transcendental moral realism and a theologically grounded, liturgical community life. The presence of creeds, daily prayer, biblical integration, and covenant theology establishes a robust foundational alignment with classical religious-metaphysical criteria.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — **CLASSICAL**

- Evidence: The mission emphasizes virtue and wisdom, formation over mere information, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty. The vision speaks of wise, virtuous students who excel academically, think biblically, and love truth, goodness, and beauty. The program describes formation via the Trivium and a classical mission oriented to human flourishing.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include formation, virtue, human flourishing, liberal education/paideia, telos, truth/beauty/goodness, and scholé (contemplation/rest). Negative sig-

nals (e.g., workforce-prep language) are not emphasized; the materials emphasize formation and virtue.

- Why this rating: The school's stated telos aligns with classical aims of fostering virtue, wisdom, and human excellence rather than solely job preparation. The emphasis on truth, goodness, and beauty as real aligns with classical telos.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: The curriculum centers on the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books and the Great Conversation, and history recast as a throughline across subjects; Latin/Greek study is noted; history is treated as history (not simply "social studies"). The program explicitly references the Great Books and the Great Conversation as part of a classical curriculum.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation; history; Latin/Greek; narration/recitation; wonder. Negative signals such as "project-based learning dominance" are not present in the Covenant materials.
- Why this rating: The explicit articulation of the Trivium, Great Books, Latin/Greek, and a throughline of history and classic texts matches the core Curriculum criteria for CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: Pedagogy emphasizes contemplative/restful elements (scholé) balanced with rigorous study; lower-school singing/chanting to deepen memory; upper-school Socratic discussion/seminars; rhetoric training and senior theses; mentorship and "living curriculum." The approach notes that Socratic education may start in high school, but a classical pedagogy can exist in K–8.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include scholé, contemplative learning, singing/chanting for memory, Socratic discussion, seminars, rhetoric, senior theses, and a teacher-led mentorship model. There are no clear signals of non-classical pedagogies (e.g., exclusive project-based or constructivist emphasis) in the public content.
- Why this rating: The materials describe a pedagogy that blends contemplative/slow-revision elements with Socratic and rhetorical methods, following the classical pedagogy framework.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: The faculty is portrayed as model teachers and mentors, part of the living curriculum; there is a "faculty of friends" approach and a visible team (Headmaster, Academic Dean, Rhetoric/Dialectic teachers) showcased on the site; mentorship is emphasized in classroom practice.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include model teachers, living curriculum, mentors, portrait of a teacher, and collegial culture; no negative signals identified in the materials.
- Why this rating: The materials present teachers as central figures in formation, with explicit mentoring roles and a clearly defined teacher profile and responsibilities. The public content supports CLASSICAL faculty criteria.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence: The school emphasizes deep partnerships with parents and church; home and church are essential supports; parents are described as co-teachers and participate through formation activities and gatherings; the site invites parent involvement and visits.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent formation, book groups and gatherings, and open campus/visit policies. No negative signals are evident in the public materials.
- Why this rating: The Covenant materials position parents as integral partners in the classical project, aligning with the six-element expectation of strong parent-community integration.

Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL

- Rationale: All six categories exhibit clear CLASSICAL alignment, anchored in a Christ-centered, Trivium-based curriculum and pedagogy, with Great Books and the Great Conversation at the core of the curriculum, a mentorship-focused faculty, and a robust partnership with families and the church. The program also includes explicit theological grounding (creeds, covenant theology) and liturgical/catechetical elements, which strengthens the religious-metaphysical dimension of classical education as defined by the rubric.

What would move the needle

- No major needle-moving changes are required given the CLASSICAL rating across all six categories. If desired, the school could further enhance alignment by explicitly foregrounding the word-level indicators from the classical lexicon (e.g., catechesis, liturgy, imago Dei, and specific references to wisdom-prudence-justice-temperance-fortitude in more explicit language across curricula) to maximize positive keyword density. However, the current public materials already demonstrate strong, explicit embodiment of these ideas.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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